LFH Case No. 062

Bradford[1]
Dec. 3rd 1873.

Friend E[2]

I dare say eer this the news of my flight eastward has reached your careless ear. Well: I have taught three days like my school very much & could not ask for a nicer class. my large boys are three which numbers is to be increased by two when the term of school at Clinton closes.

I am teaching in Mr. Helmers district. You are at home & having very lively (pg. 2) times I expect. I do not expect to go home before the Holidays would like very much to see you then. I have just one of the nicest boarding places in the world it is only a half mile from the building & I have not had to walk it but once. I pay only two and a half for my board.

Why could'nt you come out here some nice day & make me a visit?

I expect you are asking yourself why in the world dont she write with a pen & ink.[3] well I am just a little tired & therefore I take the most comfortable way of writing. I have only a half hour noon & what you see allows me to close at half past three (pg. 3) on the afternoon. I have only sixteen registered as yet but hope & expect to have more before long. O! Ettie I do love my school they are so nice. not an unpleasant one among them. I burn coal and therefore have no trouble with building fires. My school room is very dirty but they are going to clean it next Saturday.

I fear I am not going to have a chance to work off any of my flesh this winter my school is so easy. I have ever so much to tell you when an opportunity shall present its-self.

I dare say you will hear of my visit to Mr. Chases & that I did not go to Mr. P but Ettie when you know my reasons you will not blame (pg. 4) me. I did not think they were so very diceptive. But I ought not to say any thing to you about it I shall never visit them till I let them know just how I feel about it.

How very much like spring it seems I really have felt as

1. Bradford Township (Rock County Wisconsin) is just north of Clinton village and Township in south central Wisconsin. Bradford Twp. is about 12 miles southeast of Milton, Wisconsin.
2. Etta or Ettie Flagler.
3. The letter is written in pencil on blue-line school paper.

Created: 02/23/2025,18:20:00; Last revised: 03/06/2025,02:56:00; Words: 1504; Char.: 6261; DOC. Size: <Document Size>; Version: <Version Numbers>.; File Name: 1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaete A.E. Flagler, 062.odt; No. of pages: 4. Path: D:\LFH\Letters\Flagler\ODT\. LFH Id. #062. ©2024 by Craig G. Campbell, Author/Publisher, 2431 Highcrest Road, Rockford, IL 61107. LairdGordn@aol.com. All rights reserved. No part of this letter may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying, recording, or by any information storage and retrieval system, without written permission from the Author/Publisher. Originally transcribed 11/09/2004. **LFH Case No. 062**.

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though we should soon see the robbins & have an opportunity of attending the semi annual meeting of the black birds. It really did lighten last night but I dare say you did not see it for you very likely was in the arms of morpheus _____ (or some other good mans arms) but never mind they say it is a sign of warm weather.

I hear you have Miss Sion there this winter.[4] give her my kindest regards tell her I would (pg. 4)

Emma writes the following two paragraphs as crossing letters vertically superimposed over the heading and top margin of page 1.

like very much to see her Ettie the people have prophesied that I was to meet my fate this winter but I really think they will be only false prophets for I havent seen any one that looks that bad yet & I really think he is not in these parts.

May I ask if you ever hear from L.P. dear me how I do want to see you and have a real good talk but I must wait. I will send you a piece of my new black dress if I don't forget it before morning

Emma writes her address upside down in the top margin of page 4.

My address will be or is
Clinton Box 15D.[5]

4. One of Juliaette's teachers at Milton Academy or College?

5. Clinton, Wisconsin. Clinton is about 15 miles due south of Milton, Wisconsin in Rock County.

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LFH Case No. 062. 3 December 1873 letter from Emma Jane Thayer, Box 15D, Clinton, Wisconsin to Juliette A. E. Flagler, Janesville, Wisconsin. Data: 1 letter sheet; 1 letter written; Author's sex F; 1 author; author's age 21; Env.; Return address reads, "Miss Emma T, Miss Emma Thayer, Clinton, Wis"; Stamp removed; Front postmark illegible; No back postmark; No postmark time; Cursive; Pencil; Faint indecipherable oval embossing; blue-lined; No watermark; No letterhead; No complimentary close; No signature line; Postscript reads "My address will be or is Clinton Box 15D"; Thayer; Written Wednesday; TOD evening; Winter; 12.5 x 20.4 cm (5 x 8 in); 1 date; Doc. cond. fair; Legibility poor; cotton-fibre; Wotim; Crossing Letters page 1; Heading; Per. informal greeting.

Emma Thayer (b. 1852, Rock Co., Wis.) a personal friend of Juliette A. E. Flagler, lived with her family on a farm in a portion of the NE ¼ of Sec. 12 of Janesville Township. The Flagler farm was located in the SW ¼ of Sec. 1 in Janesville Township a short distance away. Her father Lindley M. Thayer (b. 1815, Maine) was married to Elizabeth Thayer (b. 1815, Maine) and both were 55 years-old in 1870 US Census. As neighbors the Thayer's and Flagler's were listed in the 1860 and 1870 US Census for Janesville, Wisconsin.

Emma Thayer begins her letter to Ettie admitting that her move "eastward" has reached Ettie's "careless ear" and that she has been teaching for three days. She adds that she likes her school very much and her class, and that her "large boys" will increase to two when the school term at Clinton, Wisconsin, ends. She states she is teaching in "Mr. Helmer's district" and then expects Ettie is having lively times at home. Emma says she won't be home before the holidays and would "like very much to see you then." Emma declares she is staying at "one of the nicest boarding places in the world" which is only one-half mile from the school, and only costing her $2.50 a month. She hasn't had to walk the half-mile yet. Emma implores Ettie to come out and visit her at Clinton and then apologizes for writing in pencil instead of pen and ink. She is tired and only has 30 minutes for lunch and her missive "allows me to close at half past three." She has only 16 registered students but expects more, and reiterates "O! Ettie I do love my school they are <u>so</u> nice. not an unpleasant one among them." She adds that she burns coal and has no trouble building fires, but her classroom is very dirty and will be cleaned next Saturday. Personally Emma doesn't think she is going to have a chance "to work off any of my flesh this winter because her teaching load is "so easy." Emma is brimming with things to tell Ettie when the opportunity arrives, and that Ettie has probably heard of Emma's visit to Mr. Chase. Emma did not go "Mr. P but Ettie when you know my reasons you will not blame me." Emma writes that she didn't think they were so deceptive and won't visit them "till I let them know just how I feel about it." But she really doesn't want to discuss it with Ettie. In her seventh paragraph Emma writes how it feels "very much like spring" and how she expects to see the Robins and the Blackbirds shortly. She adds that it lightened "last night" but presumes that Ettie didn't see it because she was asleep in the "arms of Morpheus (or some other good mans arms)." She comments that a Miss Sion is with Ettie this winter and asks her to give Miss Sion my kindest Regards and that she would like to see her. Emma then writes, "Ettie the people have prophesied that I was to meet my <u>fate</u> this winter but I really think they will be only false prophets for she hasn't seen "any one that looks <u>that bad</u> yet & I really think he is not in these parts." Emma asks Ettie if she has heard from "L.P." and writes how she must see Ettie "and have a real good talk but I must wait." Emma ends her missive to her Janesville friend stating that she will

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LFH Case No. 062. send Ettie a piece of her new black dress if she doesn't forget it before morning. In a postscript she writes out her address: "My address will be or is Clinton Box 15D." Emma J. Thayer wrote eight letters to Juliette A. E. Flagler: *1872 4 9 Letr. Emma Thayer to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 061*; *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 62*; *1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*; *1875 2 22 Letr. Emma J. Thayer 'E.J.F.' to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 095*; *1875 3 14 Letr. 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 099*; and *1874 9 20 - Letter Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*; *1876 9 8 Letter Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 132*; and *1879 5 3 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 186*. All of these letters share the same syntax and narrative style.

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